

PBL Scheduling

Current Format

- 96 Games, 48 Home & 48 Away
- North Division
 - Billings, Glacier, Great Falls, Idaho Falls, Missoula
- South Division
 - Boise, Grand Junction, Northern Colorado, Ogden, Rocky Mountain

Current format has its shortcomings

- **Teams play each other in a disproportionate way, hinders competitive balance**
- Too many unattractive meetings with teams in same division, gets boring fast
- Too little interdivision play, few chances for teams to be seen in new markets

PBL “anomalies”

- Out of 45 possible matchups, 8 do not happen (18%). Out of 90 possible H/A matchups, 28 do not happen (31%)
- Glacier (N, 84%) and Rocky Mountain (S, 88%) play almost all of their games within their divisions, while Boise (S, 56%) and Idaho Falls (N, 56%) play most of their games outside their division.
- Grand Junction plays almost 40% of home games against RMV (18/48) & only plays 5 of the 9 other teams in PBL
- NoCo plays away at only 4 other PBL teams. They only play division rivals Boise 3 times, playing more against Billings, Great Falls and Idaho, neither of which are in the South Division

The issue with Baseball...

Hard to Maintain Competitive Balance

- High number of games
- “Series” format
- Travel distances and costs
- Historically a regional sport, regional rivalries overrule
- MLB took more than 100 years to achieve a league schedule where every team plays each other, still far from being “perfectly” balanced

How to get competitive balance?

But keeping travel costs low...

Important Questions

- Does competitive balance dictate number of games or the other way around?
- What is the weight of competitive balance vs costs?
- Keep Division split for competitive purposes (two separate standings with playoff implications)? What about for scheduling purposes (“unofficial” scheduling pairings with no implication in standings)?